



Hot Skills

Hot Skills is a curated series designed to spotlight trending and critical skills that support career growth and future readiness. Each edition features a selection of skills accompanied by a clear rationale – framing each as a timely learning opportunity. Whether you're planning to develop in your existing career or learn a new skill, Hot Skills offers a quick, insightful way to help you stay one step ahead in your professional journey.

In this edition: Data Analysis

Data visualisation | Data Storytelling | Excel Analysis | Decision Making with Data

01 Data Visualisation

Why is data visualisation critical for understanding complex information?

In a data-rich environment, the ability to present information visually is essential for making insights accessible and actionable. Visuals allow stakeholders to quickly identify patterns, trends, and risks without needing deep technical expertise.

Professionals skilled in data visualization can:

- Translate complex data into clear charts, dashboards, and visuals
- Highlight trends, patterns, and anomalies at a glance
- Make insights accessible to non-technical audiences
- Improve speed and quality of decision-making



To build this hot skill, explore these courses:

- What is data visualization? (2m12s)
- Visualize data with purpose (3m3s)
- Principles of effective data visualization (1m37s)
- Data visualization with Copilot (2m59s)
- How to Use Data Visualization to Make Better Decisions—Faster (51m)
- Data Visualization for Data Analysts and Analytics (1h44m22s)

02 Data Storytelling

Why is data storytelling key to influencing decisions?

Data alone doesn't drive action—insight does. Data storytelling combines analysis with narrative to ensure findings are understood, remembered, and acted on by stakeholders.

Professionals skilled in data storytelling can:

- Frame data insights within a clear and compelling narrative
- Connect findings to business outcomes and strategy
- Influence stakeholders with structured, meaningful insights
- Make complex information memorable and actionable



To build this hot skill, explore these courses:

- Storytelling with data (2m51s)
- Presenting data through the use of storytelling (3m42s)
- Applying the Duarte Method to data storytelling (3m32s)
- Data Visualization: Storytelling (1h31m)
- Excel: Data Storytelling for Beginners (34m2s)

03 Excel Analysis

Why is Excel analysis still a foundational data skill?

Despite the growth of advanced analytics tools, Excel remains one of the most widely used platforms for data analysis, modelling, and reporting across organizations. It is often the starting point for turning raw data into insight.

Professionals who master Excel analysis can:

- Clean, organise, and analyse large datasets efficiently
- Use formulas, pivot tables, and models to generate insights
- Build reports and dashboards to support stakeholders
- Improve efficiency and accuracy in everyday data tasks



To build this hot skill, explore these courses:

- Analyze data with the Quick Analysis tool in Excel (55s)
- Perform modeling and analysis in Excel (6m33s)
- Use IF and IFS formulas to process data (7m55s)
- Excel: Managing and Analyzing Data (4h47m)
- Learning Excel: Data Analysis (3h41m)

04 Decision Making with Data

Why is decision-making with data essential for modern businesses?

Organisations are increasingly prioritizing data-driven decision-making to improve performance, reduce risk, and drive better outcomes. Using data ensures decisions are based on evidence rather than assumptions.

Professionals who use data to guide decisions can:

- Base decisions on evidence and measurable insights
- Identify opportunities and risks early
- Align actions with business goals and performance metrics
- Improve speed, confidence, and accuracy in decision-making



To build this hot skill, explore these courses:

- Understanding the value of data-driven decision-making (2m45s)
- Getting the right data for making a decision (3m1s)
- Create a decision tree to make a decision (3m44s)
- Make confident decisions with incomplete data (2m39s)
- Data-Driven Decision-Making for Business Professionals (59m)
- Data-Backed Decision Making (1h3m)